



## **Stress-free Term Paper development:**

- ✓ Organized
- ✓ Educational and
- ✓ Constructive

***Prof. Dr. Ricardo Shirota***

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# 1. Structure of a Specialization Course

- a. Start: enrollment and guidelines
- b. Subjects: theoretical and applied knowledge (methodologies)
- c. **Term Paper:**
  - i. Planning
  - ii. Execution of research/study
  - iii. Text writing
  - iv. Preparation of presentation *slides*
- d. **Final: Term Paper Presentation**
  - i. Introduction
  - ii. Argument



A high-contrast, black and white close-up of a person's eye, looking directly at the viewer. The eye is the central focus, with the iris and pupil clearly visible. The surrounding skin and eyelashes are in sharp focus, creating a dramatic and intense effect.

## 2. Importance of the Term Paper

### a. Why Term Paper?

### b. What to expect from it?

#### i. Tool of:

- ✓ Synthesis
- ✓ Reflection
- ✓ Knowledge application

#### ii. Connection with career

- ✓ Professional differentiator

A high-contrast, black and white close-up of a person's eye, looking directly at the viewer. The eye is the central focus, with the iris and pupil clearly visible. The surrounding skin and eyelashes are also in focus, creating a dramatic and intense visual.

## 2. Importance of the Term Paper

Opportunity to acquire important professional skills:

- a. **Develop a critical eye**
  - i. Professional experience
  - ii. Theoretical knowledge
- b. Application of technical knowledge to propose solutions to problems

### 3. Why are Term Papers considered “traumatic”?

- a. The student fails to understand, or to recognize, the importance of the Term Paper in their training
- b. Poor or nonexistent planning
- c. Procrastination
- d. Bad “Execution”



## 4. Term Paper development stages

a. Research/study planning

b. Research execution

c. Term Paper writing



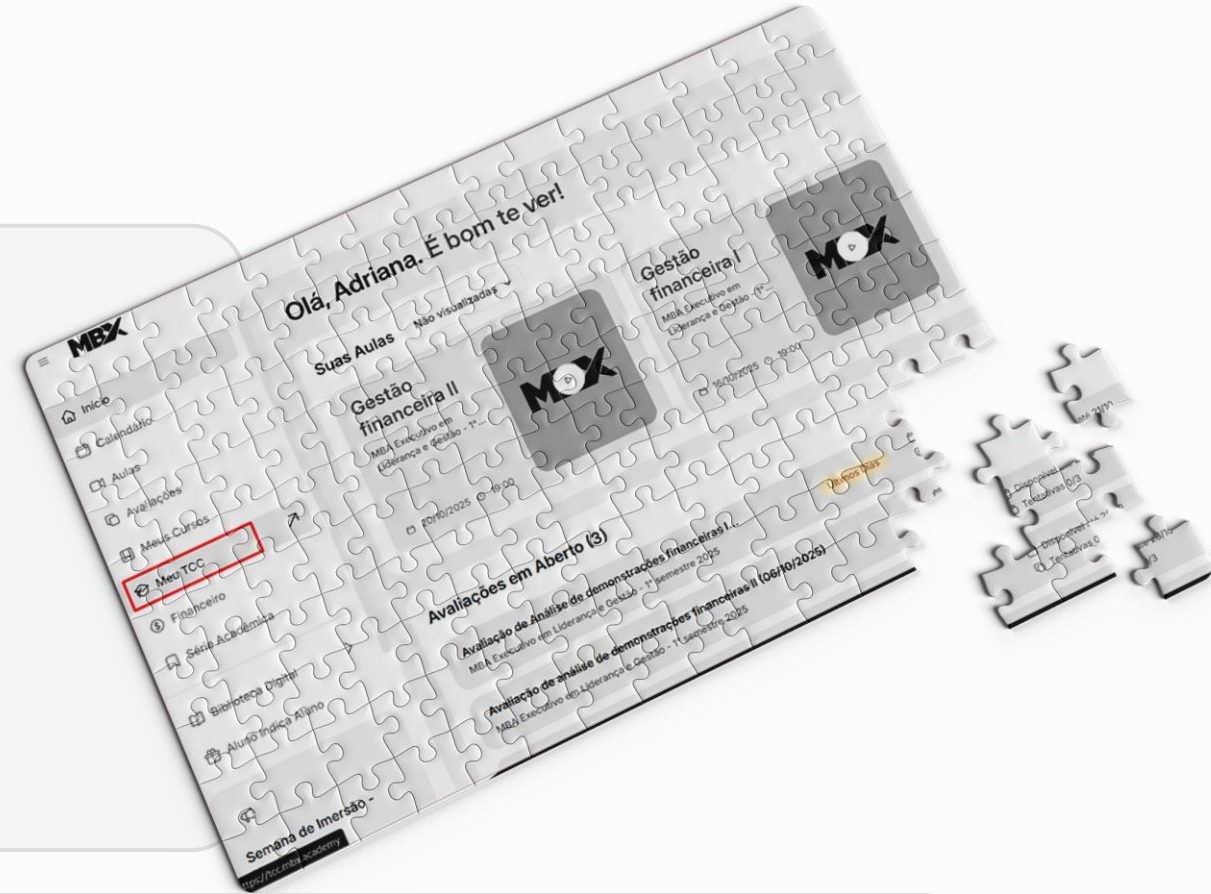
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## 5. Research planning

### a. “The problem”

- i. Identify
- ii. Qualify / Detail
- iii. Justify (show its importance)
- iv. What is already known (literature review)?
- v. What is not yet known?
- vi. Define the objective(s)



### b. Define/Choose the methodology

- i. Analytical tools (how the problem will be studied/measured/analyzed to propose a “solution”)
- ii. Necessary data (which and how to obtain them?)

## 6. Execution of the study

- a. Data collection and cleaning
- b. Presentation of the data obtained (optional)
- c. Feed the cleaned data into the chosen “analytical model”
- d. Obtain the results
  - i. Present the results (tables, charts, figures, diagrams, etc.)
  - ii. Analyze the results obtained and discuss their implications



# 7. Writing the Term Paper

## a. Introduction

- i. The problem and its justification
- ii. “Context” of the study
- iii. Objectives of the Term Paper
- iv. Hypotheses (optional)

## b. Methodology

- i. Description of the “analytical tools” and justification for its selection (literature review)
- ii. Description of how data was collected and analyzed



# 7. Writing the Term Paper

## c. Results

- i. Presentation of the results obtained by applying the methodology (described previously): tables, diagrams, figures, charts, etc.
- ii. Analysis and discussion of the results: what new insights do the results reveal?

## d. Conclusion (or Final Considerations)

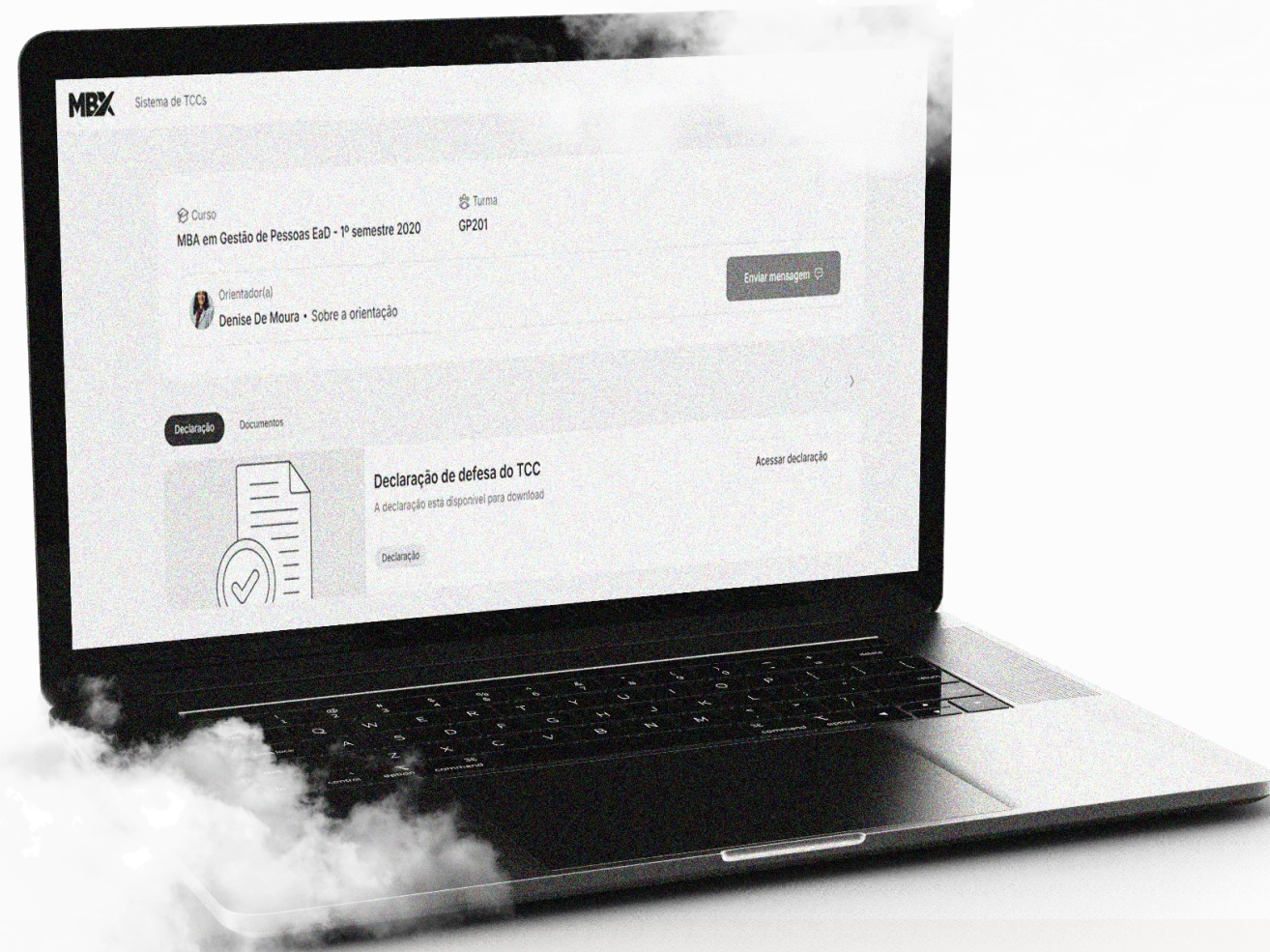
**Note: Do not repeat what was previously presented in the text**

- i. What are the study's contributions for “decision-making” purposes?
- ii. What are the limitations of the study?
- iii. What suggestions can be made for “future studies”?



## 8. Some suggestions

- a. Consult / Stay in contact with the advisor
- b. Start early (at the beginning of the course)
- c. Do not procrastinate / do not put things off
- d. Use the Term Paper to develop professional skills that will become ***your competitive advantage*** in the job market
- e. See the Term Paper as an ***opportunity for professional development***, not as an “obstacle” to earning your degree



## 9. What is a “good Term Paper”?

### a. Have

- i. A well-defined problem
- ii. Appropriate methodology
- iii. Data obtained correctly
- iv. “Good” (correct) results
- v. Conclusions consistent with the study

### b. Contain a “solution” to the proposed problem



***Thank you!***

Prof. Dr. Ricardo Shirota

**MBA** **USP**  
**ESALQ**



## **Structure and Tools**

***Prof. Dr. Renato Barbosa***

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# Term Paper structure

| Element      | Information, title or subtitle        | Insertion in the document |
|--------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Pre-textual  | Cover sheet                           | Mandatory                 |
|              | Title                                 |                           |
|              | Abstract or Executive Summary         |                           |
|              | Keywords                              |                           |
| Textual      | Abstract or Abstract                  | Mandatory                 |
|              | Keywords                              |                           |
|              | Introduction                          |                           |
|              | Methodology (or Material and Methods) |                           |
|              | Results and Discussion                |                           |
| Post-textual | Conclusion or Final Considerations    | Optional                  |
|              | Acknowledgements                      |                           |
|              | References                            |                           |
|              | Appendix (es)                         |                           |
|              | Attachment (s)                        |                           |

# Term Paper Structure - Introduction

the text of the section must be separated from the title by a single character space, written in Arial font size 11, with 1.5 line spacing and a first-line indent of 1.25 cm in each paragraph, justified on both the right and left margins;

- In this section, the use of bullet points and the inclusion of tables, figures, or charts is not permitted;
- in the last paragraph of the Introduction, the objective of the research must be coherently and directly stated; and
- the Introduction must not exceed two pages (depending on specific characteristics of the topic and vocabulary, two pages contain approximately 35 lines).

| Trabalho de Conclusão de Curso apresentado para obtenção do título de especialista em<br>(Nome do curso) – (ano da defesa)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Trabalho de Conclusão de Curso apresentado para obtenção do título de especialista em<br>(Nome do curso) – (ano da defesa)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    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em<br>(Nome do curso) – (ano da defesa)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------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| <p><b>Título do trabalho de conclusão de curso</b> (o título deve ser curto, claro, objetivo e conclusivo. Deve conter no máximo 120 caracteres e não conter expressões redundantes como: "Título de:", "Título sobre:", "Título sobre o:", "Título de:", "Análise de:", "Estudo de:", "Efeito de:", "Valor de:").</p> <p>nome completo aluno<sup>1</sup>; nome completo orientador<sup>2</sup></p> <p><small><sup>1</sup> Titulação: Nome da Empresa ou Instituição (opcional). E-mail autor correspondente: nome@email.com<br/><sup>2</sup> Titulação: Nome da Empresa ou Instituição (opcional). E-mail: nome@email.com</small></p> | <p><b>Título do trabalho de conclusão de curso</b></p> <p><b>Resumo (ou Sumário Executivo)</b></p> <p>O resumo é uma descrição geral do trabalho, apresentando de forma sucinta todas as seções do TCC. No caso do curso de MBA em Gestão de Projetos, em função das particularidades do trabalho – que pode ser um plano de projeto – é facultado aos alunos o uso do termo <b>Sumário Executivo</b>. Essa seção deve ser escrita de forma clara e objetiva, informando ao leitor em que consiste o TCC e o fim de despertar o seu interesse para a leitura de todo o trabalho. Os termos <b>Resumo</b> (ou <b>Sumário Executivo</b>) e <b>Palavras-chave</b> devem ser grafados em negrito, alinhados à esquerda com apenas a primeira letra da palavra em letra maiúscula. O <b>Resumo</b> ou <b>Sumário Executivo</b> deve conter no máximo 250 palavras, sendo redigido em um único parágrafo, em espaçamento simples e no tempo verbal pretérito perfeito do indicativo (passado). O início da seção deve conter uma curta apresentação sobre a importância/justificativa (contextualização do tema) do trabalho. Em seguida, é necessário apresentar o objetivo geral, que deve ser redigido de maneira sucinta e direta. Ademais, a seção deve conter uma breve descrição da metodologia empregada na pesquisa, abordando os aspectos mais importantes para o entendimento do TCC. É importante destacar os principais resultados obtidos a partir da pesquisa, apresentando relações e/ou considerações que chamem a atenção do avaliador e do público em geral. O final do resumo (ou sumário executivo) deve conter uma conclusão geral (com uma ou duas frases). Deve-se ter cuidado para não repetir a descrição dos resultados nessa seção.</p> <p><b>Palavras-chave:</b> (insira até cinco palavras diferentes das contidas no título, separadas por ponto-e-vírgula).</p> <p>Atenção: antes de enviar o arquivo para o Sistema de TCCs, remova todas as instruções originais que estão abaixo do conteúdo dos tópicos.</p> <p><b>Introdução</b></p> <p>A história da evolução da ciência é marcada por momentos de grandes descobertas e avanços que moldaram o pensamento humano ao longo dos séculos. Desde as primeiras observações astronômicas feitas por civilizações antigas, até as mais recentes descobertas no campo da física quântica, a ciência tem sido uma ferramenta crucial para o entendimento do universo e o desenvolvimento de tecnologias que impactam diretamente o cotidiano das pessoas.</p> <p>Nos primeiros tempos da humanidade, os astrônomos tentaram compreender os movimentos dos corpos celestes e o lugar da Terra no universo. Civilizações como a grega e a egípcia buscaram por padrões e explicações para os fenômenos naturais que observavam. Essas observações levaram a uma série de teorias, algumas das quais ainda são estudadas hoje, como o modelo heliocêntrico de Nicolau Copérnico.</p> <p>No entanto, a verdadeira revolução científica começou com as contribuições de cientistas como Isaac Newton e Albert Einstein, cujas teorias mudaram completamente nossa visão sobre as leis da física. Newton, com sua teoria da gravitação universal, explicou como os corpos se atraem entre si, enquanto Einstein desafiou a visão newtoniana com sua teoria da relatividade, revelando um universo mais complexo do que se imaginava anteriormente.</p> | <p>Durante o século 20, a física quântica emergiu, oferecendo uma nova forma de entender as partículas subatômicas e os fenômenos que ocorrem em escalas microscópicas. O estudo das partículas elementares levou a inovações tecnológicas que transformaram a indústria moderna, como os computadores e a internet.</p> <p>O avanço das ciências também trouxe novas perguntas e desafios. Questões éticas sobre a manipulação genética e os limites da pesquisa científica tornaram-se tópicos importantes nos debates contemporâneos. A forma como a ciência é conduzida e aplicada na sociedade tem implicações significativas, e é fundamental que os cientistas, filósofos e cidadãos estejam envolvidos nesse debate para garantir que o progresso seja alinhado com os princípios éticos. A busca pela verdade e pelo conhecimento continua sendo uma das forças motrizes da humanidade. Embora muitas perguntas já tenham sido respondidas, ainda há muito a descobrir, e a ciência continuará a ser uma fonte de inspiração e inovação para as futuras gerações.</p> <p>Os TCCs dos cursos de especialização <b>USP/ESALQ</b> devem apresentar um caráter aplicado. Pesquisas Bibliográficas ou documentais, ou seja, formas de pesquisa baseadas exclusivamente em dados não experimentais, somente serão aceitas se elaboradas juntas (ou em conjunto) utilizando métodos de análise de metadados ou grupos de dados. Todos os trabalhos deverão ser executados de forma que os alunos utilizem as ferramentas e os conhecimentos adquiridos ao longo do curso. As situações excepcionais, quando houver, serão avaliadas pela coordenação do programa. Recomenda-se que a escolha do tema seja realizada em função da identificação com a área de conhecimento e/ou demanda profissional do aluno. Além disso, é fundamental que antes de iniciar a redação do TCC, o aluno considere se terá acesso ineditado aos dados necessários, fontes de consulta e, principalmente, se a metodologia da pesquisa está ao alcance do conhecimento e domínio do assunto, tanto do aluno quanto do orientador.</p> <p>As pesquisas envolvendo a participação, direta ou indireta, de seres humanos, a experimentação com animais e aquelas pesquisas que representem risco potencial ao meio ambiente devem obedecer a um conjunto de diretrizes específicas. Nesse sentido, é responsabilidade do aluno e orientador conhecerem as regras pertinentes à sua área de pesquisa e submeterem ou não o projeto ao Comitê de Ética. Para mais informações, consulte o "Manual de Instruções e Normas para Trabalhos de Conclusão de Curso".</p> <p>O título da seção Metodologia ou Material e Métodos deve ser grafado em negrito, alinhado à esquerda e com as primeiras letras das palavras em letra maiúscula. O texto da seção deve ser redigido no pretérito perfeito do indicativo (passado) na forma impessoal e pode ser dividido em subtópicos, conforme formatação descrita no item 16.4 Metodologia ou Material e Métodos.</p> |

# Term Paper Structure - Introduction

## General Topic

•**Description:** The broadest section of the funnel. It is here that you present the general context of your field of study. The idea is to introduce the reader to a broad and relevant topic that involves the research area.

•**Function:** To create an overview of the problem or question, contextualizing the area and highlighting its importance.

## 2. Background

•**Description:** Deepens the discussion of the general topic by presenting data, facts, or previous research that are essential for understanding the problem or research question.

•**Function:** To provide a background on which the research will be built, showing the evolution of the problem and existing gaps in the literature.

## 3. Specific Topic

•**Description:** Here, the topic is narrowed further to a specific aspect within the broader context. This part clearly defines the focus of your research and delimits the scope.

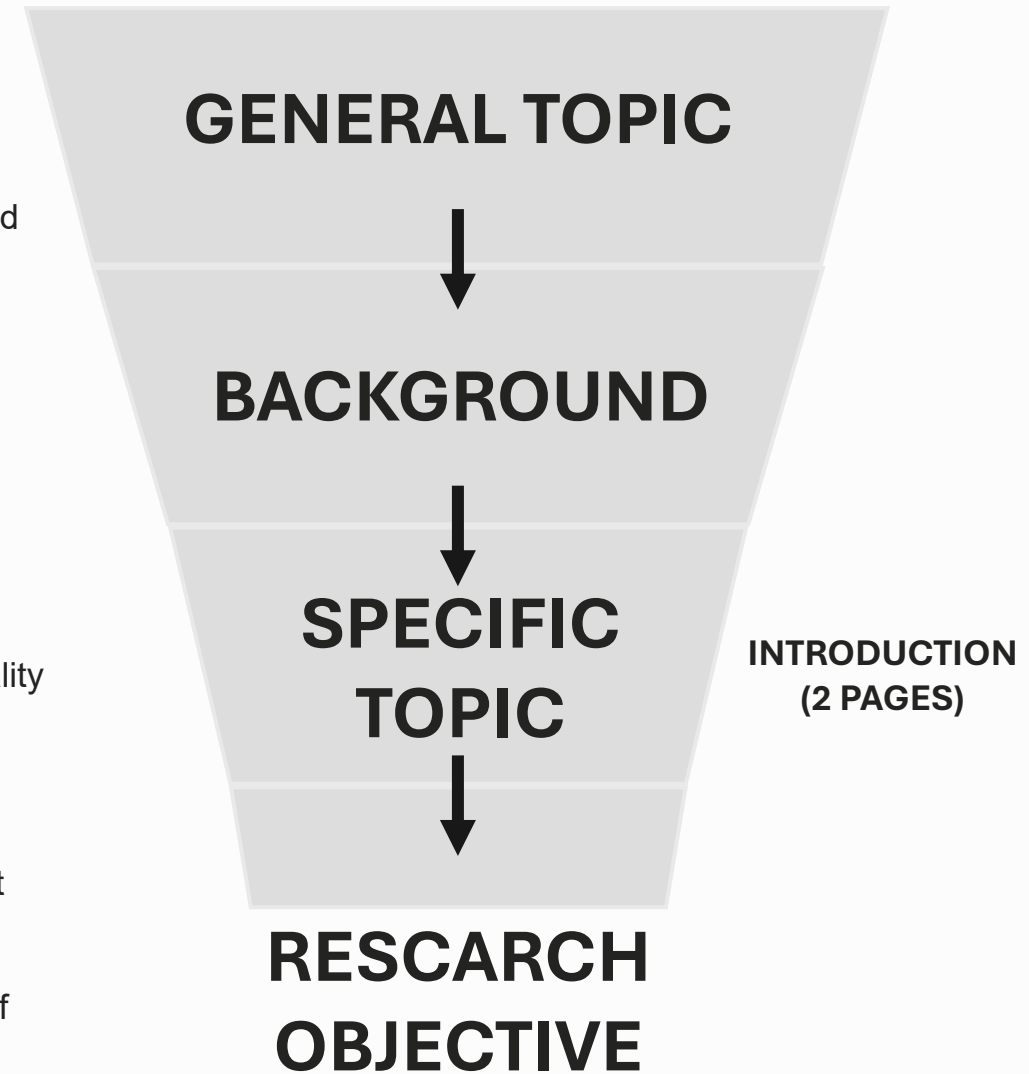
•**Function:** To present the exact area that will be investigated, explaining how the work connects with what has already been discussed, but at the same time highlighting originality or the need for further study.

## 4. Research Objective

•**Description:** The narrowest point in the funnel, where the objective of the research is explicitly declared. It clearly defines what it wants to achieve with the study.

•**Function:** To determine the central research question, which will be explored throughout the paper. The objective must be specific, measurable, and aligned with the research proposal.

This structure helps guide the reader from an overview of the topic to the specific focus of the research, providing a logical and cohesive flow for the introduction of your academic work.



# Term Paper Structure – Problem and Objective

g1

G1

Mulher sangra até a morte em hospital de Olinda; amiga denuncia que equipe médica foi negligente por achar que ela fez aborto

Woman bleeds to death in Olinda hospital; friend claims medical staff was negligent for assuming she had an abortion

A chef de cozinha Paloma Alves Moura, de 46 anos, morreu após passar quase dez horas aguardando atendimento médico no Hospital do...

Chef Paloma Alves Moura, 46, died after waiting nearly ten hours for medical attention at the Hospital ...

5 dias atrás

R7

R7

Família denuncia negligência médica após morte de bebê em Jacareí (SP)

Family reports medical negligence after baby's death in Jacareí (SP)





A criança, que apresentava dificuldades respiratórias, foi diagnosticada com cólica e tratada apenas com medicamento para gases.

The child, who had breathing difficulties, was diagnosed with colic and treated only with gas medication.

6 dias atrás

g1

G1

Polícia investiga denúncia de negligência médica após homem morrer no banheiro de UPA em Catanduva

Police investigate allegations of medical negligence after man dies in bathroom of emergency care unit in Catanduva

Um homem de 56 anos morreu no sábado (18) depois de passar mal dentro do banheiro de uma Unidade de Pronto Atendimento (UPA) em Catanduva...

A 56-year-old man died on Saturday (18) after falling ill in the bathroom of an emergency care unit (UPA) in Catanduva ...

6 dias atrás



MENU

g1

CIÊNCIA E SAÚDE

Poor healthcare kills more than lack of access to doctors, study says

Atendimento precário mata mais do que a falta de acesso a médicos, diz estudo

No Brasil, são 153 mil mortes por ano por causa de atendimento médico de má qualidade. Estudo foi feito em 137 países de baixa e média renda.

Por G1

06/09/2018 06h01 - Atualizado há 7 anos





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# Term Paper Structure – Problem and Objective

**Practical analogy:**

The **problem** is the *medical diagnosis* (“what is happening and why?”);

the **objective** is the *prescribed treatment* (“what are we going to do to solve this?”).

| Problem                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Expected objective                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• High dropout rates in high school</li><li>• Failures in communication between sectors of the company</li><li>• Difficulty adapting to working from home</li></ul> | <p>Identify the main causes of dropout and propose measures to reduce it</p> <p>Analyze the communication flow and suggest improvements</p> <p>Investigate the impacts of working from home and propose adaptation strategies</p> |

**Can you do this exercise?**

# Term Paper Structure – Problem and Objective



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228 visualizações • há 10 dias



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151 visualizações • há 1 mês



**Essa Ideia Nasceu do MBA - Simone Silotti - MBA em Gestão de Projetos**

488 visualizações • há 2 meses

# Term Paper Structure – Theoretical framework

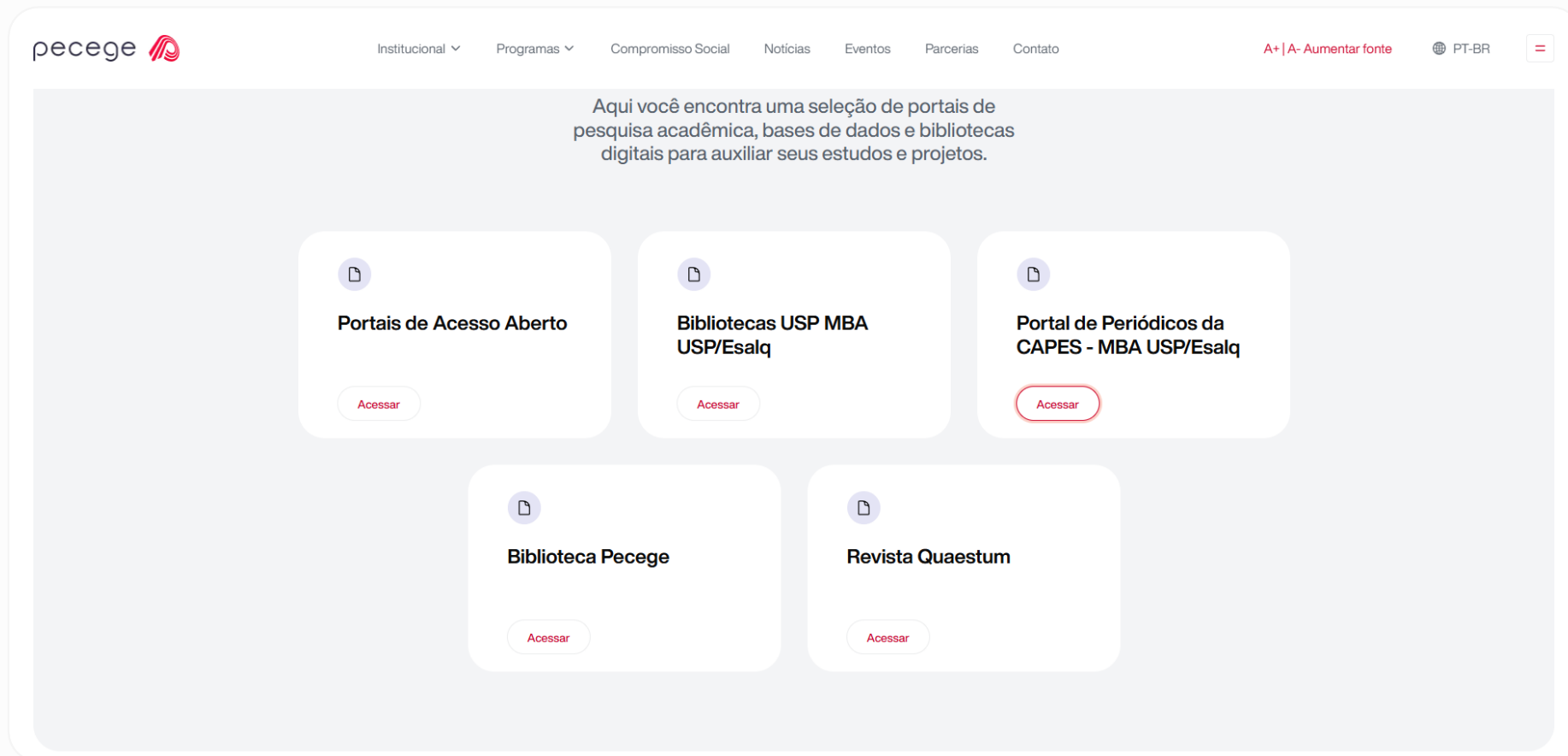


# Term Paper Structure – Theoretical framework

The screenshot displays the 'Minha Biblioteca' website interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation links: 'Início', 'Pesquisar', 'Catálogo', 'MINHAS ESTANTES', 'Meus Livros', 'Favoritos', 'Ajuda', and 'Comentários'. The top header features the site logo and a search bar containing the text 'Gerenciamento de projetos'. The main content area shows search results under the 'Títulos' tab. It lists 'Todos os resultados de títulos' and indicates '1 - 10 de 14 resultados para "Gerenciamento de projetos"'. Two results are visible: 1) 'Gerenciamento de projetos' by Harold Kerzner, Editora Blucher, with an 'eBook' label and buttons for 'Abrir o livro' and 'Exibir detalhes'. 2) 'Gerenciamento de Projetos' by Marta Rocha Camargo, 2ª edição, with an 'eBook' label and an 'Abrir o livro' button.

# Term Paper Structure – Theoretical framework

➤ Research portals (<https://pecege.com/portais-de-pesquisa>)



# Term Paper Structure – Theoretical framework

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Resumo ▼

Adicionar outro campo

Buscar

# Term Paper Structure – Theoretical framework

The screenshot shows a Google Acadêmico search for 'business case' on the Brazilian domain. The search results are filtered to show articles from 2024 onwards. The left sidebar contains filters for date, language, and type of document. The main results list three articles, each with a title, author, source, and a brief abstract. The first article is 'Moving beyond "the" business case: How to make corporate sustainability work' by T. Busch, M. L. Barnett, and R. L. Barnett, published in Business Strategy in 2024 by Wiley Online Library. The second article is 'The unstated ontology of the business case study: Listening for indigenous voices in business school curricula' by J. Hrenyik and E. Salmon, published in Academy of Management Learning & Teaching in 2024 by journals.aom.org. The third article is 'The business case for carbon farming in the USA' by A. Plastina, H. Jo, and O. Wongpiyabovorn, published in Carbon Balance and Management in 2024 by Springer. Each article entry includes a star icon to save, a citation icon, the number of citations, related articles, and a link to all versions.

scholar.google.com.br/scholar?as\_ylo=2024&q=business+case&hl=pt-BR&as\_sdt=0,5

Google Acadêmico business case FAZER LOGIN

Artigos Aproximadamente 207.000 resultados (0,08 s) Meu perfil Minha biblioteca

A qualquer momento  
Desde 2025  
Desde 2024  
Desde 2021  
Período específico...

Ordenar por relevância  
Ordenar por data

Em qualquer idioma  
Pesquisar páginas em Português

Qualquer tipo  
Artigos de revisão

☐ incluir patentes  
☒ incluir citações

☒ Criar alerta

**Moving beyond "the" business case: How to make corporate sustainability work** [PDF] wiley.com  
T. Busch, M. L. Barnett, R. L. Barnett - Business Strategy ..., 2024 - Wiley Online Library  
... environmental initiatives, the **business case** for sustainability is ... but further develop our **business case** understanding. In this view, ... Specifically, we argue that an effective **business case** ...  
☆ Salvar Citar Citado por 60 Artigos relacionados Todas as 14 versões

**The unstated ontology of the business case study: Listening for indigenous voices in business school curricula**  
J. Hrenyik, E. Salmon - Academy of Management Learning & ..., 2024 - journals.aom.org  
... how **business case** studies can support decolonial Indigenization efforts in **business** schools...  
We argue that the ways in which **business case** studies are written influences the ways they ...  
☆ Salvar Citar Citado por 9 Artigos relacionados Todas as 2 versões

**The business case for carbon farming in the USA** [PDF] springer.com  
A. Plastina, H. Jo, O. Wongpiyabovorn - Carbon Balance and Management, 2024 - Springer  
US agricultural producers are increasingly able to participate in private voluntary carbon initiatives that compensate their efforts to sequester CO<sub>2</sub>, reduce GHG emissions, and provide ...  
☆ Salvar Citar Citado por 8 Artigos relacionados Todas as 13 versões

**Beyond the business case: Impacts and resilience post-adoption of decentralized renewable energy for rural livelihoods**  
V. Shastri, V. Raj - Energy for Sustainable Development, 2025 - Elsevier  
Productive uses of energy – tied to the usage of energy for economically productive appliances – to catalyze improvements in livelihoods, healthcare, and education have gained ...  
☆ Salvar Citar Citado por 1 Artigos relacionados

# Term Paper Structure – Material and Methods



## Methodology: Defined Research Location

- Research begins with a basic focus, but still without many details or organization.
- Research Location:** The only aspect defined so far is the place where data will be collected.
- Weakness:** The methodology is still “raw,” lacking proper structure. The data collection and analysis process still needs to be clearly defined.

# Term Paper Structure – Material and Methods

## 2. Second Image - Cake with Messy Frosting

### Methodology: Location, Period, Cost, and Necessary Resources

- The research now has a more robust structure. In addition to the data collection location, the period and cost of the research were defined.
- Research Period:** Defines when the research will occur, helping in organizing the schedule.
- Cost and Resources:** The cost estimate for research and necessary resources (equipment, materials, etc.) were identified, but execution is still at the beginning.
- Weakness:** The structure is not yet fully defined, with the methodology requiring further refinement to be efficient.



# Term Paper Structure – Material and Methods

## 3. Third Image - Cake with Well-Applied Frosting

### Methodology: Definition of Samples, Collection Instruments, and Analysis Type

- The research is beginning to take shape, with the essential details of sampling and instruments defined.
- Samples:** The research population or sample was clearly defined, specifying segmentation and selection criteria.
- Data Collection Instruments:** The method and tools for data collection were chosen, such as questionnaires, interviews, observations, or records.
- Type of Data Analysis:** The form of analysis (quantitative, qualitative, or mixed) has already been defined, which begins to outline how data will be handled.



# Term Paper Structure – Material and Methods

## 4. Fourth Image - Cake with Precise Decoration

**Methodology: Data Analysis Planning, Ethical Procedures, and Possible Limitations**

- The research now has a detailed methodology with clear analysis and a defined ethical approach.
- Data Analysis:** Analysis methods are more refined, with definition of statistical or qualitative analysis techniques.
- Ethical Procedures:** The research began to focus on ethical issues such as informed consent, confidentiality, and data security.
- Research Limitations:** Limitations and possible biases were recognized, anticipating potential challenges. The research is now well-structured and almost ready to be executed.



# Term Paper Structure – Material and Methods

## 5. Last Image - Perfectly Decorated Cake

### Methodology: Complete and Well-Structured Methodology

- The research methodology is finally complete, with all aspects well-defined and aligned.
- Clear Objective:** The methodology already clearly defines what will be investigated, why, and how it will be performed.
- Defined Execution:** The research execution process is clearly outlined, with all resources, schedule, and costs aligned.
- Execution and Expected Results:** The research is now fully organized, and execution can be started with a solid basis, ensuring relevant and reliable results.



# Term Paper Structure – Results and Discussion

- Shows the impact and meaning of the research.
- Transforms data into insights and conclusions.
- Relates results to literature and objectives.

Present results clearly (charts, tables) and interpret critically.

The discussion must compare findings with relevant authors and highlight practical implications.

# Term Paper Structure – Results and Discussion

1. Present the main result.
2. Interpret the meaning (why it occurred).
3. Compare with literature (3 to 5 authors per topic):
  - Classic and recent (last 5 years).
  - Relevant to the topic and context.
4. Show practical implications and recommendations.



## **Example:**

78% of employees report a lack of feedback → Failure in internal communication.  
According to Chiavenato (2021) and Robbins (2020), feedback is essential for engagement

# Term Paper Structure – Results and Discussion

- Use charts, tables, and comparative panels with captions and sources.
- Prefer clean visual and consistent with objectives.
- Analyze critically: relate results + theory + practice.
- Note limitations and possible developments.

## Checklist:

- ✓ Do results respond to the objectives?
- ✓ Is there comparison with literature?
- ✓ Is the evidence clear and well-illustrated?

# Term Paper Structure – Conclusion



- It must be objective and clear
  - Respond to the objective of the research

# Tips: Research Project



## First Steps

- Topic: choose a subject aligned with the area of interest and activity.
- Sources: use only reliable and updated materials (blogs are not allowed).
- Objective: structure clearly and coherently with the work proposal.



## Suggested structure for Introduction

- Present the topic based on scientific definitions.
- Show the relevance using numbers and/or data from the studied context.
- Cite current studies on the topic.
- Clearly delimit the problem to be investigated.

Introduction should be written in up to 2 pages, without figures or tables



## Websites for searching scientific papers

- Google Scholar
- SciELO
- PECEGE Library
- CAPES Portal
- BDTD (Brazilian Digital Library of Theses and Dissertations)
- 



## Recommendations for the Objective

Verbal form: always start with a verb in the infinitive (e.g., analyze, propose, evaluate, investigate).

Ensure coherence between problem → objective → method.

Practical example:

✗ Study innovation in companies. (generic, shows neither focus nor method).

✓ Analyze the innovation practices adopted by a small IT company located in the interior of São Paulo. (specific, applied, and viable).

# Tips: Preliminary Results



## Methodology

- Explain how data was collected and analyzed.
- Indicate instruments, techniques, and tools used.
- Method must be clear and coherent.

Example:

-  Document analysis will be performed.
- Annual financial reports of 3 healthcare organizations will be analyzed, with thematic content analysis.



## When interviews are applied

- Present the roadmap and selection criteria in the methodology.
- Justify the sample.
- Ensure ethical principles (consent agreement).

Example:

-  Interviews were conducted with people from the company.
-  Online, semi-structured interviews with 10 managers of family businesses, validated roadmap, and signed consent agreement.



## When a questionnaire is applied

- Show the instrument's objective.
- Describe sample and target audience.
- Explain data analysis.

Example:

-  We applied a questionnaire to students.
-  A structured questionnaire of 20 questions was applied with 50 students from technical courses, analyzed with descriptive statistics.



## Preliminary Results

- Present initial data (if data collection is not yet complete). Relate to objective and existing studies.

Example:

-  Data were analyzed
-  Data from 50 students compared to studies on school dropout, showing convergences and divergences.
- Citations: only indirect (paraphrase). Reliable sources. Avoid blogs or informal materials. Example:
  -  According to a blog ..., motivation is important.
  -  Chiavenato (2014) highlights that motivation is a determining factor for organizational performance.

# Tips: Term Paper



## Academic Writing

- Use short sentences, with direct construction, avoiding ambiguities.
- Avoid colloquial expressions, informal abbreviations, or oral markers. The text must reflect academic rigor and impersonality.
- The text must follow the scientific article standard, as defined by MBA USP / Esalq, structured as:
  - Introduction
  - Methodology (or Materials and Methods)
  - Results and Discussion
  - Conclusion (or Final Considerations).



## Foundation and Discussion of Results

- Relate theory and practice critically.
- Use current and relevant references.
- Avoid accumulation of citations without own analysis.
- Use only indirect citation (paraphrase). Example:

Kotler (2010) highlights that marketing is fundamental for the competitiveness of modern companies.



## Tables, Figures and References

### Tables and Figures

- Number and title according to the institutional model.
- Ensure readability and clarity.
- Indicate the source of each table / figure.

Example:

Table 1. Research results with medium-sized companies

Source: Original research results

### References

- List all sources used.
- Format according to the institutional model.
- Update whenever new sources are included.



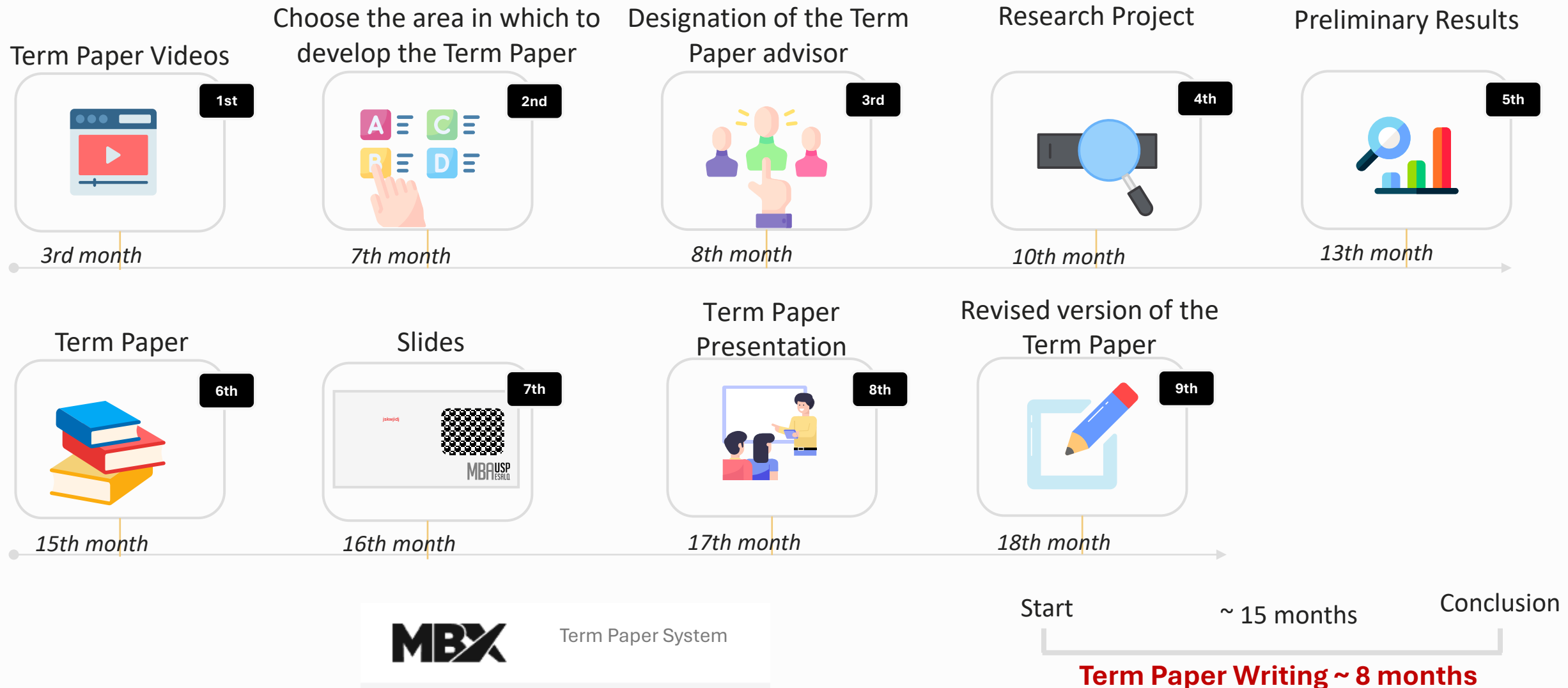
## General Formatting

- DO NOT use ABNT (follow institutional manual).
- Review margins, fonts, spacing, and alignment.
- Equations and formulas must be standardized.
- Write out the first occurrence of acronyms / foreign terms.

Example: Environmental, Social and Governance [ESG].

Note: always check the instructions and formatting guidelines manual.

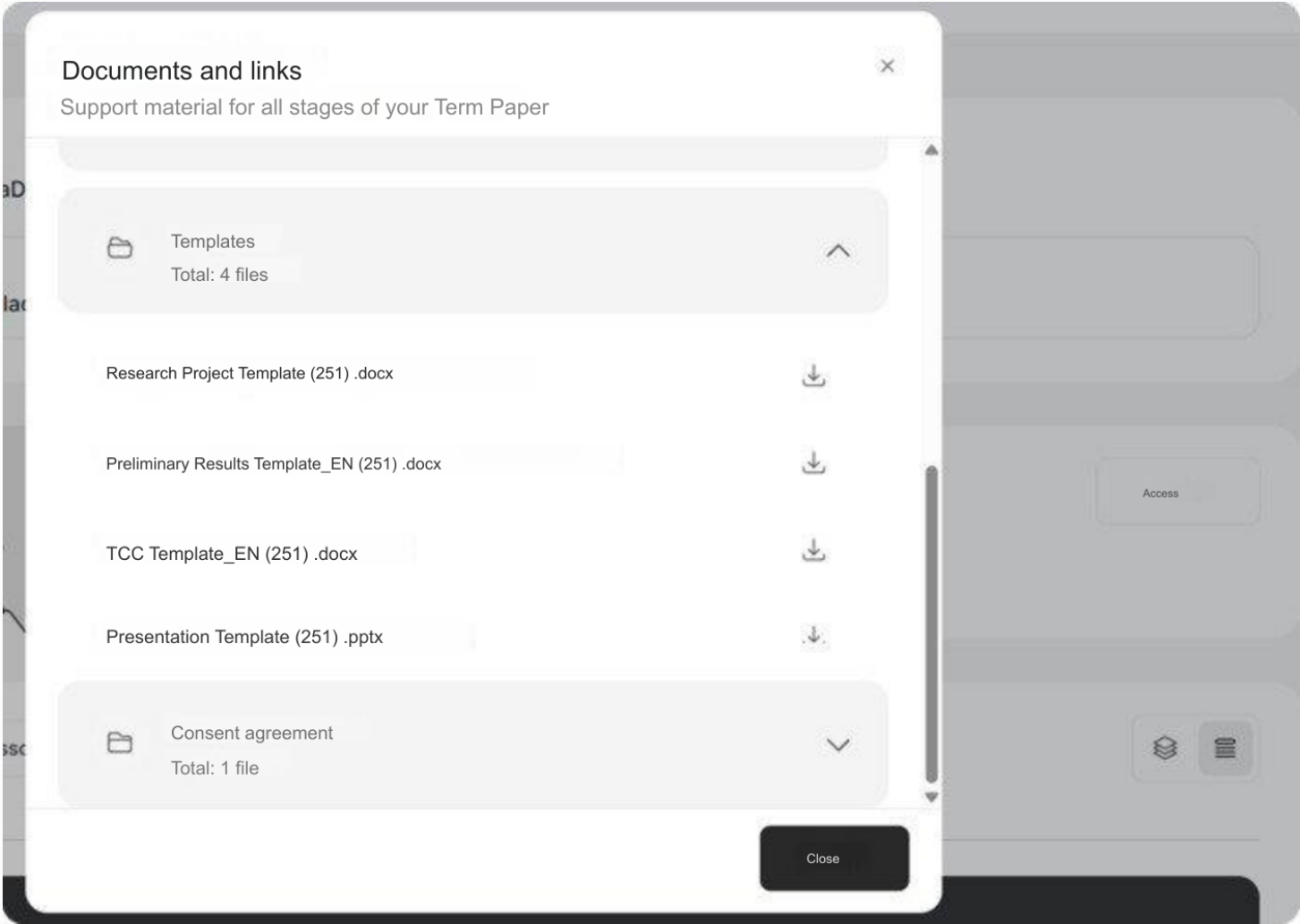
# Term Paper development period



# MBX – Term Paper System

|                                                   |                                             |                                                                                       |                       |                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Coming soon                                       |                                             |                                                                                       |                       |                                                                                       |
| Research Project<br>3rd Stage                     | Due date March 25, 2026 April 1, 2026       |                                                                                       | Status<br>Coming soon |    |
| Preliminary results<br>4th Stage                  | Due date June 9, 2026 June 16, 2026         |                                                                                       | Status<br>Coming soon |    |
| Term Paper<br>5th Stage                           | Due date September 22, 2026 October 6, 2026 |                                                                                       | Status<br>Coming soon |    |
| Slides<br>6th Stage                               | Due date October 13, 2026 November 3, 2026  |                                                                                       | Status<br>Coming soon |    |
| Revised version of<br>the Term Paper<br>7th Stage | Deadline                                    |  | Status<br>Coming soon |  |

# MBX – Term Paper System



# Term Paper Development Schedule – MBA USP/Esalq

Suggested planning for writing and sending versions.

Balance between reading, writing, revising, and collecting data.

## Institutional deadlines:

- Research Project: March 25 to April 1, 2026
- Preliminary Results: June 9 to June 16, 2026
- Term Paper Submission: September 22 to October 6, 2026

# 1 Start of Research Project

1 January – March/2026

- Choice of topic and alignment with advisor.
- Read recent articles in Google Scholar.
- Definition of the problem, objective, and initial methodology.
- Submit the draft by March 10, 2026 for revision.
- Submission in the System: March 25 to April 1, 2026.

| Week                | Main activities                                                                                  | Submissions / Expected results                                       |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1st to 2nd (Jan)    | Reading recent articles in Google Scholar; selection of topics applied to the professional area. | Mind map with 2 or 3 topic options.                                  |
| 3rd to 4th (Jan)    | Choose final topic and define problem and objective.                                             | Draft with: topic, problem, objective, and initial methodology.      |
| 1st fortnight (Feb) | Submission of the <b>initial draft</b> to the advisor (email/system chat).                       | Initial feedback.                                                    |
| 2nd fortnight (Feb) | Revise text according to guidelines and begin formatting in the Word template.                   | 1st Version of the Research Project.                                 |
| 1st to 2nd (Mar)    | Complete sections: Introduction, Objective, Methodology, Expected Results.                       | Complete version sent by <b>March 10, 2026</b> .                     |
| 3rd to 4th (Mar)    | Adjustments and final revision according to feedback from the advisor.                           | Submission in the system between <b>March 25 and April 1, 2026</b> . |

# 2 Collection and Preliminary Results

1 April – June/2026

- Application of questionnaires, interviews, or data analysis.
- Organizing results in spreadsheets and charts.
- Submission of the preliminary version to the advisor by May 25, 2026.
- Official submission of Preliminary Results: June 9 to June 16, 2026.

| Official period                                                                                             | June 9 to June 16, 2026 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Submit text with: Introduction, Material, and Methods, beginning of Results and Discussion, and References. |                         |
| Revise according to the feedback from the advisor before official submission.                               |                         |

| Week                      | Main activities                                                        |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| April (1st to 3rd week.)  | Application of questionnaires, interviews, or company data collection. |
| April (last week.)        | Compilation of data and initial organization into spreadsheets/charts. |
| May (1st fortnight)       | Initial analysis of data and comparison with literature.               |
| Until <b>May 25, 2026</b> | Submission of the preliminary version to the advisor for correction.   |

## 3 Development and Final Version

1 July – August 2026

- Completion of the analysis and writing Results and Discussion.
- Compare with literature (3 to 5 authors per topic).
- Submit complete version by August 4, 2026 to the advisor.
- Revisions, adjustments, and similarity verification (Turnitin).

| Week                    | Main activities                                                                           |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| July (1st to 2nd week.) | Completion of data collection and comprehensive analysis.                                 |
| July (3rd to 4th week.) | Write <b>Results and Discussion</b> comparing with literature (3 to 5 authors per topic). |
| August (until August 4) | Submission of the complete version to the advisor for revision.                           |
| August (2nd fortnight.) | Final revisions, citation adjustments, formatting, and Turnitin.                          |

## 4 Extension and Final Submission

1 July – October 2026

- Revise complete Term Paper according to the advisor's feedback.
- Check title, summary, methods, and references.
- Final submission in the System: September 22 to October 6, 2026.

### Official period

September 22 to October 6, 2026

Check final checklist: title, summary, introduction, methods, results, discussion, final considerations, references, and appendices.

Check the Turnitin report and submit the final version through the system.

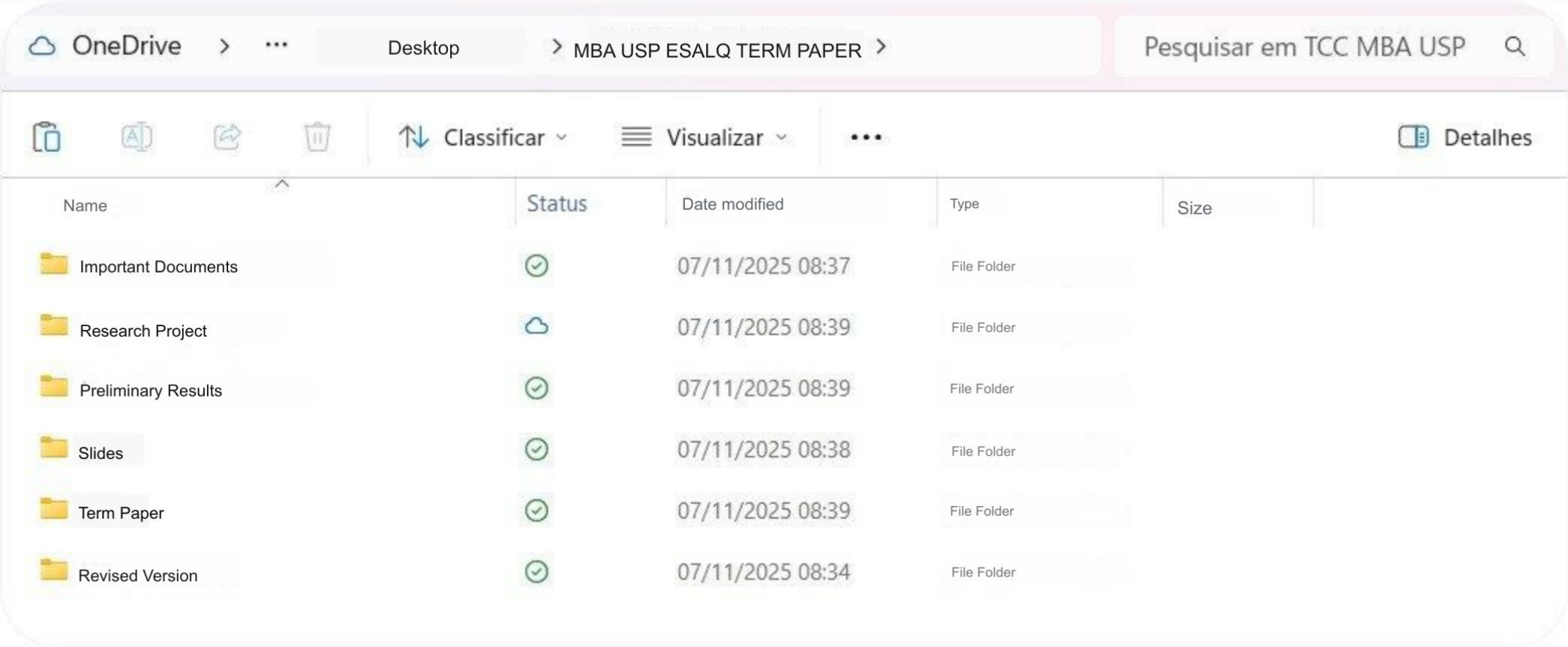


# Weekly Writing Routine

- Monday: revise notes and update plan.
- Tuesday: write 1–2 pages.
- Wednesday: bibliographic search (Google Academic, Scielo, etc.).
- Thursday: revise text and insert citations.
- Friday: update spreadsheets and charts.
- Saturday: critical reading or meeting with advisor.
- Sunday: rest or light reading.

| Day       | Suggested activity                                     |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Monday    | Revise notes and update writing plan.                  |
| Tuesday   | Write 1–2 pages of new text (any section).             |
| Wednesday | Bibliographic research (Google Scholar, Scielo, etc.). |
| Thursday  | Revise written text and insert citations.              |
| Friday    | Update spreadsheets, figures, or flowcharts.           |
| Saturday  | Critical reading or meeting with advisor.              |
| Sunday    | Rest or light reading of articles.                     |

# Document organization



The screenshot shows the OneDrive web interface. The breadcrumb path is OneDrive > Desktop > MBA USP ESALQ TERM PAPER. A search bar on the right says 'Pesquisar em TCC MBA USP'. The toolbar includes icons for file operations and a 'Classificar' (Sort) dropdown. The main content area displays a table of folders.

| Name                | Status | Date modified    | Type        | Size |
|---------------------|--------|------------------|-------------|------|
| Important Documents | ✓      | 07/11/2025 08:37 | File Folder |      |
| Research Project    | ☁      | 07/11/2025 08:39 | File Folder |      |
| Preliminary Results | ✓      | 07/11/2025 08:39 | File Folder |      |
| Slides              | ✓      | 07/11/2025 08:38 | File Folder |      |
| Term Paper          | ✓      | 07/11/2025 08:39 | File Folder |      |
| Revised Version     | ✓      | 07/11/2025 08:34 | File Folder |      |

# Document organization

OneDrive

MBA USP ESALQ TERM PAPER

Important Documents

Pesquisar em Documentos I

Classificar

Visualizar

Details

| Name                                                                                                                                      | Status                                                                                         | Date modified    | Type               | Size     |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|--------------------|----------|
| <div> General instructions for developing a ...</div>    | <div></div>   | 07/11/2025 08:36 | Documento do Ad... | 1.097 KB |
| <div> Manual of Instructions and Standards for ...</div> | <div></div>   | 07/11/2025 08:36 | Documento do Ad... | 1.453 KB |
| <div> Research Methodologies for ...</div>               | <div></div>   | 07/11/2025 08:36 | Documento do Ad... | 1.763 KB |
| <div> Term Paper Project Management_EN</div>            | <div></div>  | 07/11/2025 08:36 | Documento do Ad... | 1.531 KB |
| <div> Consent agreement (251)</div>                    | <div></div> | 07/11/2025 08:37 | Documento do Mi... | 136 KB   |

# Document organization

OneDrive

MBA USP ESALQ TERM PAPER

Research project

Pesquisar em Projeto de pes

Classificar

Visualizar

Details

| Name                                                                                                                          | Status                                                                               | Modification Date | Type                  | Size  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------|-------|
|  Bibliographic Research                      |   | 07/11/2025 08:39  | Pasta de arquivos     |       |
|  Fluxo de caixa_Renato Barbosa_07112025      |   | 07/11/2025 09:00  | Planilha do Micros... | 9 KB  |
|  Projeto de Pesquisa_Renato Barbosa_07112025 |   | 07/11/2025 08:54  | Documento do Mi...    | 13 KB |
|  Template Projeto de Pesquisa (251)         |  | 07/11/2025 08:37  | Documento do Mi...    | 82 KB |

***Thank you!***

Prof. Dr. Renato Barbosa

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